Delhi[53]; all of these institutions tap into the idea of the Taj as the representation of Indian/Oriental royal splendor and luxury.

Recognition has continued into the new millennium. In 2007, the Taj was named as one of the "New7Wonders," a list that was created through a global campaign of online voting. Over 100 million votes were cast, and the modern list included Chichén Itzá, the Christ the Redeemer statue in Rio de Janeiro, the Great Wall of China, Machu Picchu, the Colosseum, and the ruins of Petra in Jordan[54]. The campaign galvanized international interest and demonstrates how the Taj is able to command loyalty from numerous visitors and fans.

Because it stands so central to the world's imagination of India, those who have sought to attack India have, at times, threatened the Taj. During World War II, the British covered the dome with a protective scaffolding, but the feared Japanese invasion of India was turned back in Assam. In 1971, there was fear about the role of the building in war. India was supporting the partition of Pakistan and Bangladesh, and it was feared that Pakistani planes flying over northern India would use the building as a navigational landmark - especially because it is so luminescent at night. In response, the structure was shrouded in black[55]. In 2001, plans were put into motion to repeat this “camouflage” in case of another war[56]. That said, there was never a fear that the Pakistanis would destroy the building, since it represents a triumphal example of their own Muslim ancestors' architectural and political apogee.